

Skills Summary

One Number, Three Ways: Dots, Numerals, Words

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — From Dots to a Numeral

Rule: Count the objects one at a time. The last number you say is *how many*, and the **numeral** is that number written with digits.

Example: Count: • • • • • — write the numeral.

Step 1. Count the dots one-to-one, then write the last number said as a numeral.

Step 2. “One, two, three, four, five” — the count ends at five, so the numeral is **5**.

Try it: Count: • • • • — write the numeral.

check: 4

Skill 2 — Number Words

Rule: Every numeral has a name you can spell:

one 1	two 2	three 3	four 4	five 5
six 6	seven 7	eight 8	nine 9	ten 10

Example: The card says *eight*. Write the numeral.

Step 1. A number word and a numeral are two ways to write the same number — find *eight* in the counting sequence.

Step 2. *Eight* comes after seven and before nine, so the numeral is **8**.

Try it: The card says *three*. Write the numeral.

check: 3

(!) Watch out: *Six* and *seven* start with the same sound. Check the whole word before you write the numeral.

Skill 3 — From a Numeral to a Quantity

Rule: A numeral tells you *how many to show*. A ten-frame helps: fill the top row of five first, then keep going in the bottom row.

Example: Show the numeral 6 as dots on a ten-frame.

Step 1. Fill the top row of five first, then count on until the count reaches the numeral.

Step 2. Top row: five dots. One more makes $5 + 1 = 6$ — six dots in all.

Try it: To show the numeral 9, you fill the top row of five. How many dots go in the bottom row?

check: 4